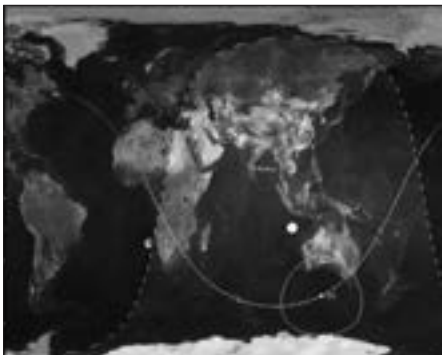


Orbitron 6.0

www.stoff.pl

This one is a must for all you aspiring astronauts and sci-fi junkies. Did you know there are more than 8,000 satellites orbiting the earth? That since 1957 when the Russians shot up Sputnik—man’s first artificial satellite—more than 20,000 satellites have circled the earth at some point or the other? No? Well, so didn’t we! And that doesn’t stop us from going nuts over Orbitron.



Orbitron—Beam us up!

This is a free satellite tracking program that shows you the current position of any of the 8,000+ satellites in orbit, on a world map. The screenshot shows the current position of the ISS (International Space Station). The satellite telemetry data is updated almost daily, and you can update it directly over the Internet or manually download and update the program.

The program interface may be a bit confusing at first, and you will need to spend some time trying to figure out what’s what. That, we think, is more than half the fun! Click on the location tab and select your city from the drop-down on the right, or at the left, enter the name of your city and give its latitude and longitude. You can also right-click on a spot on the map and select the “Pick Location” option. There are quite a few other options—which we aren’t getting into because, like we said, half the fun is in finding out.

Finally: Orbitron is free but it’s not freeware. It’s cardware. The program author Sebastian Stoff requests, if you like the program, to send him a postcard! So, while you dream up satellite trajecto-